

Recommended Industry and Job Category Taxonomy for a Hiring Platform

Research basis

This taxonomy is designed for a hiring platform, not for an economic census. That distinction matters. Official systems such as NAICS and ISIC classify businesses by their primary economic activity, while occupational systems such as SOC and *ONET* classify the type of work a person does. *The most usable job platform therefore needs both dimensions: an industry layer for employer identity and a job category* layer for role-family filtering.* That separation is also consistent with BLS definitions and with LinkedIn's recruiter tooling, which treats industry and job function as different filters and explicitly notes that industry alone does not reliably indicate a person's skills or job role. ¹

The backbone of the industry list below is drawn from the current NAICS 2022 structure and aligned with the broader ISIC framework, which both use hierarchical classification and are designed to classify economic activity in a mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive way. For front-end usability, however, I recommend a more job-platform-friendly layer than the 20 NAICS sectors alone. That is consistent with current market practice: LinkedIn states that its industry taxonomy is aligned to NAICS and organized hierarchically, and ISIC Rev. 5 has expanded detail in several areas to reflect newer economic activity patterns. ²

The list also reflects modern labor market realities. Remote and hybrid work remain materially important: BLS reported that 22.6 percent of workers teleworked in March 2026, and recent work-from-home research estimated that work from home accounted for about one quarter of paid workdays in the United States in 2023–2025. At the same time, gig work is best understood as a form of contingent or self-employed work arrangement, not as an industry in itself. For platform design, that means **workplace type** and **employment type** should be separate filters alongside industry and job category. ³

Design rules for a platform taxonomy

The recommended approach is a two-layer public taxonomy with a hidden standards mapping behind it. Employers should first choose a single **Industry Classification** that best matches the employer's primary business, then choose a **Job Category** that best matches the vacancy's field of work. In the database, each public-facing industry can map to one or more NAICS and ISIC codes, and each job category can map to one or more SOC/O*NET families or occupations. This preserves user clarity while keeping reporting, analytics, and integrations standards-compatible. ⁴

A good public taxonomy should be recognizable at a glance, low-friction to self-select, and specific enough to improve search precision without becoming a maze. NAICS itself is revised every five years to reflect changes in economic activity, and ISIC Rev. 5 added more detail in information services, environmental

activity, finance, and culture. That is a strong signal that a job platform should expect periodic taxonomy maintenance rather than treat the dropdowns as static forever. ⁵

I also recommend that the platform keep **remote, hybrid, on-site, full-time, part-time, contract, temporary, internship, and volunteer** as separate searchable attributes rather than mixing them into industries or job categories. LinkedIn's job-post editing fields already separate workplace type, employment type, job function, and company industry, and LinkedIn's recruiter help explicitly warns that industry does not necessarily reflect job role. ⁶

Master industry classifications

I recommend the following **25 user-facing Industry Classifications** for the primary employer-industry dropdown:

1. Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing & Aquaculture
2. Energy, Mining & Utilities
3. Environmental Services & Sustainability
4. Construction & Building Services
5. Manufacturing & Industrial Production
6. Transportation, Logistics & Warehousing
7. Automotive & Mobility
8. Wholesale & Distribution
9. Retail & E-commerce
10. Healthcare
11. Social Services & Nonprofit
12. Pharmaceuticals, Biotechnology & Life Sciences
13. Education & Training
14. Government & Public Administration
15. Aerospace, Defense & Public Safety
16. Financial Services & Insurance
17. Real Estate, Property & Facilities
18. Legal
19. Consulting, Professional & Business Services
20. Technology, Software & IT Services
21. Telecommunications & Network Infrastructure
22. Media, Publishing & Entertainment
23. Advertising, Marketing & Public Relations
24. Hospitality, Travel & Tourism
25. Consumer Services & Personal Services

This list keeps a standards-based backbone while making several deliberate user-facing splits that improve posting accuracy and search behavior. The most important splits are: **Healthcare** from **Social Services & Nonprofit**; **Technology, Software & IT Services** from **Telecommunications & Network Infrastructure** and from **Media, Publishing & Entertainment**; and **Environmental Services & Sustainability** as a separate front-end option. Those choices are consistent with the distinction between industry and occupation in BLS/O*NET, with LinkedIn's hierarchical filter model, and with recent ISIC revisions that added

detail for cloud, information services, environmental remediation, renewable generation, arts, and culture.

7

Copy-paste-ready industry and job category list

The list below is formatted for direct implementation as a second-level dropdown after industry selection.

Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing & Aquaculture

Use when the employer's primary business is farming, ranching, forestry, fishing, aquaculture, or agricultural support services. This is a user-facing version of the official agriculture, forestry, fishing, and hunting sector. 8

- Farm & Ranch Operations
- Crop Production & Agronomy
- Animal Care & Livestock
- Forestry, Logging & Land Management
- Fishing, Aquaculture & Marine Harvesting
- Agricultural Equipment & Maintenance
- Food Safety, Quality & Compliance
- Agricultural Sales, Supply & Advisory

Energy, Mining & Utilities

Use for oil and gas, mining, electric power, gas distribution, water, wastewater, and related utility infrastructure employers. Official classifications treat these as core production and utility activities, and recent standards also add clearer renewable-energy detail. 9

- Exploration, Extraction & Drilling
- Utility Operations for Power, Gas, Water & Wastewater
- Renewable Energy Operations
- Grid, Transmission & Distribution
- Plant Maintenance & Reliability
- Process, Mechanical & Electrical Engineering
- Health, Safety, Environmental & Regulatory Compliance
- Energy Markets, Commercial & Regulatory Affairs

Environmental Services & Sustainability

Use for waste, recycling, remediation, environmental consulting, climate programs, and sustainability-focused employers. ISIC Rev. 5 explicitly adds carbon remediation and more detailed environmental activity, which supports a distinct front-end industry on a hiring platform. 10

- Waste, Recycling & Circular Economy Operations
- Environmental Consulting & Permitting
- Sustainability Strategy & ESG
- Remediation, Decontamination & Site Cleanup
- Carbon, Climate & Decarbonization Programs
- Conservation, Natural Resources & Habitat Management
- Environmental Field Sampling & Laboratory Services

- Environmental Program Management & Compliance

Construction & Building Services

Use for general contractors, specialty trades, civil construction, construction management, and building-service project firms. Construction remains a distinct top-level industry in both NAICS and BLS supersectors.

11

- Preconstruction, Estimating & Bidding
- Project Management & Scheduling
- Skilled Trades
- General Labor & Site Operations
- Civil, Structural & Surveying
- MEP, HVAC, Plumbing & Electrical Systems
- Safety, Quality & Inspection
- Building Service, Maintenance & Facilities Projects

Manufacturing & Industrial Production

Use for factories, industrial plants, processors, and product manufacturers. NAICS treats manufacturing as one of the core goods-producing sectors, and O*NET/SOC provide a strong basis for production, engineering, maintenance, and quality role families within it.

12

- Production Operations & Assembly
- Industrial Engineering & Process Improvement
- Maintenance, Reliability & Millwright Services
- Quality Assurance & Quality Control
- Production Planning, Procurement & Supply Chain
- Plant Management & Continuous Improvement
- Research, Product Development & Prototyping
- Warehouse, Shipping & Materials Handling

Transportation, Logistics & Warehousing

Use for carriers, freight firms, couriers, warehouse operators, brokerages, and supply-chain providers. This aligns with the transportation and warehousing sector and with current market demand for fulfillment and last-mile work.

13

- Driving, Piloting & Vehicle Operations
- Dispatch, Routing & Traffic Coordination
- Warehouse Operations & Inventory Control
- Freight Forwarding, Brokerage & Customs
- Fleet Maintenance & Transportation Equipment Repair
- Supply Chain Planning & Logistics Analytics
- Last-Mile Delivery & On-Demand Fulfillment
- Transportation Safety, Compliance & Claims

Automotive & Mobility

Use for dealerships, repair networks, automotive suppliers, fleet operators, mobility services, and EV-related employers. This is a platform-oriented split across activities that standards distribute across

manufacturing, retail, transportation, and repair, but that users commonly experience as one industry family. ¹⁴

- Vehicle Service & Repair
- Collision, Body & Paint
- Parts, Service Advising & Dealership Operations
- Automotive Sales & Finance Office
- Manufacturing & Assembly
- Mobility, Fleet & Rental Operations
- EV Systems, Charging & Battery Service
- Automotive Engineering, Diagnostics & Calibration

Wholesale & Distribution

Use for B2B distributors, merchant wholesalers, agents, and import-export wholesalers. Wholesale trade is a distinct NAICS sector and should stay separate from retail because employer identity, channel economics, and role patterns differ materially. ¹⁵

- Category Buying & Merchandising
- Account Management & B2B Sales
- Distribution Center Operations
- Inventory, Replenishment & Demand Planning
- Procurement & Supplier Management
- Pricing, Trade Support & Sales Operations
- Product Specialists & Technical Sales Support
- Import, Export & Channel Operations

Retail & E-commerce

Use for businesses that sell directly to consumers through stores, marketplaces, direct-to-consumer sites, or omnichannel models. ISIC Rev. 5 removes the distinction between online and in-store sales channels at the section level, so e-commerce fits best as a job-category domain inside retail rather than as its own top-level industry. ¹⁶

- Store Leadership & Multi-Unit Management
- Sales Floor & Customer Service
- Cashiering, Checkout & Loss Prevention
- Merchandising, Buying & Planning
- E-commerce Operations & Marketplace Management
- Fulfillment, Pickup & Returns
- Visual Merchandising & Store Experience
- Retail Analytics, CRM & Loyalty

Healthcare

Use for hospitals, physician groups, clinics, ambulatory care, diagnostics, and care-delivery organizations. Official statistical systems often combine health care with social assistance, but a recruiting taxonomy works better when direct care is separated from nonprofit and human-services organizations. ¹⁷

- Physicians & Advanced Practice Providers
- Nursing

- Allied Health & Rehabilitation
- Behavioral Health & Counseling
- Diagnostic, Imaging & Laboratory Services
- Healthcare Administration & Revenue Cycle
- Health Information, Informatics & Healthcare IT
- Patient Support, Care Coordination & Nonclinical Services

Social Services & Nonprofit

Use for human-services agencies, charities, foundations, advocacy groups, community organizations, and mission-driven nonprofits. This front-end split improves search relevance for employers and candidates whose work is social-service or nonprofit-led rather than clinical healthcare. ¹⁸

- Case Management & Social Work
- Counseling, Crisis & Behavioral Support
- Program Delivery & Community Outreach
- Advocacy, Policy & Public Affairs
- Fundraising, Grants & Development
- Volunteer, Member & Donor Operations
- Nonprofit Finance, Compliance & Administration
- Shelter, Youth, Family & Human Services Support

Pharmaceuticals, Biotechnology & Life Sciences

Use for drug developers, biotech firms, medical-research organizations, contract research organizations, and scientific laboratories. O*NET's current occupation set includes fast-growing data, scientific, and sustainability-adjacent roles, and life sciences increasingly need their own front-end classification because they blend research, regulated manufacturing, and commercialization. ¹⁹

- Discovery Research & Preclinical Science
- Clinical Research & Trials
- Bioprocessing, Manufacturing & Scale-Up
- Quality Assurance, Validation & GxP Compliance
- Regulatory Affairs & Pharmacovigilance
- Laboratory Operations & Analytical Testing
- Bioinformatics, Biostatistics & Scientific Data
- Medical Affairs, Field Science & Commercialization

Education & Training

Use for schools, colleges, universities, tutoring providers, e-learning organizations, and workforce-training providers. Education is a distinct top-level sector in NAICS and is also increasingly differentiated by modality, including e-learning and workforce upskilling. ²⁰

- Early Childhood Education
- K-12 Teaching
- Postsecondary Teaching & Academic Research
- Special Education & Student Support
- Instructional Design & Curriculum Development
- School Administration & Academic Leadership
- Admissions, Advising & Registrar Services

- Corporate Training, Coaching & Workforce Development

Government & Public Administration

Use for civil government agencies, public offices, regulators, administrative departments, and public programs. Public administration remains a distinct activity in international classifications and differs operationally from private-sector business services. ²¹

- Policy, Analysis & Program Administration
- Permitting, Licensing & Regulatory Services
- Clerical, Records & Public-Facing Administration
- Public Finance, Budget & Procurement
- Public Works, Infrastructure & Operations
- Courts, Legislative & Government Affairs Support
- Social Benefit Administration & Case Processing
- Inspection, Code Enforcement & Compliance

Aerospace, Defense & Public Safety

Use for aerospace manufacturers, defense contractors, mission-support firms, emergency services, and protective-service employers. This front-end industry groups highly specialized safety-critical employers that users commonly search together even though standards may disperse them across manufacturing, government, and service categories. ²²

- Aerospace Engineering & Avionics
- Defense Systems, Mission & Program Management
- Manufacturing, Assembly & Precision Production
- Maintenance, Repair & Overhaul
- Quality, Airworthiness & Configuration Control
- Security, Intelligence & Protective Services
- Emergency Response, Fire & Rescue
- Training, Simulation & Technical Documentation

Financial Services & Insurance

Use for banks, lenders, fintechs, insurers, brokerages, investment firms, and payments providers. Finance and insurance is a distinct NAICS sector, and recent ISIC revisions add more detail to newer financial activities. ²³

- Retail & Commercial Banking
- Lending, Credit & Underwriting
- Investment, Trading & Asset Management
- Financial Planning, Advisory & Wealth Management
- Insurance Claims, Adjusting & Risk Services
- Actuarial, Quantitative & Financial Analysis
- Compliance, AML & Financial Crime
- Operations, Payments & Client Service

Real Estate, Property & Facilities

Use for brokerages, developers, landlords, property managers, REITs, title firms, and facilities operators.

Real estate and rental/leasing is a distinct standards category, while facilities work is a practical front-end extension for hiring use. ⁸

- Property Management & Leasing
- Real Estate Sales, Brokerage & Agency Support
- Development, Acquisitions & Investment
- Appraisal, Title & Transaction Services
- Facilities Management & Building Operations
- Maintenance, Grounds & Building Services
- Space Planning, Workplace & Tenant Experience
- Real Estate Finance, Asset Management & Compliance

Legal

Use for law firms, in-house legal departments, legal-process providers, and court-support employers. BLS and O*NET treat legal work as a distinct occupational family, and job seekers commonly search legal opportunities separately from broader professional services. ²⁴

- Attorneys & Counsel
- Paralegal, Legal Assistant & Docketing
- Contracts, Compliance & Corporate Governance
- Litigation Support, eDiscovery & Trial Services
- Intellectual Property, Privacy & Regulatory Law Support
- Court Reporting, Transcription & Legal Operations
- Intake, Client Relations & Case Administration
- Legal Research, Knowledge & Library Services

Consulting, Professional & Business Services

Use for consulting firms, accounting firms, staffing providers, outsourced-service firms, and broad business-service organizations. This aligns with the professional, scientific, technical, management, and administrative-service areas in NAICS while remaining simpler for users. ²⁵

- Management & Strategy Consulting
- Accounting, Audit & Tax
- Human Resources, Recruiting & Staffing
- Engineering, Architecture & Technical Consulting
- Project, Program & Change Management
- Business Analysis & Process Improvement
- Customer Success, Account Management & Service Delivery
- Outsourced Operations, Contact Center & Back Office
- Research, Insights & Advisory Services

Technology, Software & IT Services

Use for software companies, SaaS firms, IT service providers, managed service providers, cloud companies, and enterprise technology vendors. ISIC Rev. 5 explicitly separates publishing/content from telecommunications/computing, creates a new cloud-infrastructure group, and integrates cybersecurity

activity into software and information-management activities, which strongly supports a dedicated technology industry. ²⁶

- Software Engineering & Application Development
- Product Management & Product Design
- Data, AI & Machine Learning
- IT Infrastructure, Cloud & Platform Engineering
- Cybersecurity & Identity
- Quality Assurance, Testing & Release Engineering
- IT Support, Help Desk & End-User Services
- Solutions Architecture, Implementation & Technical Consulting

Telecommunications & Network Infrastructure

Use for carriers, fiber providers, network operators, broadband firms, and telecom infrastructure companies. This separation is directly supported by ISIC Rev. 5's split of information and communication into content/publishing versus telecom/computing activities. ¹⁰

- Network Engineering & Architecture
- Field Installation & Service Technicians
- NOC, Service Assurance & Operations
- Wireless, Fiber & Broadband Deployment
- Telecom Project Management & Construction
- RF, Spectrum & Network Optimization
- Customer Provisioning, Technical Support & Repair
- Regulatory, Carrier Relations & Wholesale Operations

Media, Publishing & Entertainment

Use for publishers, broadcasters, streaming companies, studios, creators, production houses, and entertainment businesses. ISIC Rev. 5 explicitly moves toward a separate publishing, content production, and distribution section, which makes this a strong front-end industry for hiring platforms. ¹⁰

- Journalism, Editorial & Content Production
- Video, Audio & Broadcasting Operations
- Creative, Design & Art Direction
- Production Management, Studio & Events
- Talent, Artist & Creator Management
- Rights, Licensing & Distribution
- Audience Growth, Community & Platform Operations
- Post-Production, Motion Graphics & Technical Media

Advertising, Marketing & Public Relations

Use for agencies, in-house marketing organizations, PR firms, creative shops, and growth-marketing teams. Users routinely search these roles as a coherent market distinct from publishing or software, even when employers exist in many industries. LinkedIn's use of job-function filtering also supports this role-family distinction. ²⁷

- Brand & Product Marketing
- Performance Marketing & Paid Media

- Content Marketing, Social Media & Community
- Public Relations, Communications & Media Relations
- Marketing Operations, CRM & Automation
- Market Research, Insights & Analytics
- Creative Services, Copywriting & Campaign Production
- Partnerships, Events & Experiential Marketing

Hospitality, Travel & Tourism

Use for hotels, resorts, travel operators, tour companies, event venues, and guest-experience businesses. Standards group accommodation and food services together, but a hiring platform benefits from a broad hospitality/travel bucket centered on guest service and travel operations. ²⁸

- Hotel, Resort & Lodging Operations
- Front Office, Guest Services & Reservations
- Housekeeping, Facilities & Property Care
- Food Service, Culinary & Beverage
- Travel Planning, Tour Operations & Destination Services
- Events, Meetings & Banquets
- Revenue Management, Sales & Distribution
- Recreation, Wellness & Guest Experience

Consumer Services & Personal Services

Use for beauty, wellness, repair, home-service, care, and local personal-service employers. This is the broadest user-facing bucket and captures employers that standards often place in personal and repair services or other local service classes. It also provides a home for platform-mediated and freelance consumer-service work without turning “gig economy” into an industry label. ²⁹

- Beauty, Spa & Wellness Services
- Fitness Coaching & Personal Training
- Home Services, Cleaning & Household Support
- Repair, Installation & Personal Technical Services
- Childcare, Eldercare & In-Home Support
- Customer Service, Scheduling & Front Desk
- Franchise, Multi-Location & Service Business Management
- On-Demand, Freelance & Platform-Based Services

Implementation notes

For production use, store this as a **display taxonomy** rather than as the only classification system in your database. The industry selected by employers should map to one or more NAICS/ISIC codes, and the job category selected for the vacancy should map to one or more SOC/O*NET families or occupations. That approach preserves reporting quality while giving employers and job seekers a cleaner interface than standards-only coding would provide. ³⁰

The most important supporting filters should sit outside this taxonomy: **workplace type** for remote, hybrid, or on-site; **employment type** for full-time, part-time, contract, temporary, internship, volunteer, and seasonal; **seniority**; **location**; and **skills**. LinkedIn’s job-post and recruiter products already model these as

separate fields, and BLS distinguishes industry, occupation, class of worker, and telework as separate concepts. ³¹

If you want a practical implementation rule set, use this operating logic: require one industry, require one primary job category, allow up to two secondary tags, and reserve a hidden **Other / Multi-Industry** fallback only for imports and edge cases. That keeps the public taxonomy clean while still handling unusual employers, conglomerates, and legacy data. The result is closer to how modern hierarchical taxonomies are actually used in recruiting systems: broad at level one, searchable and recognizable at level two, and standards-mapped behind the scenes. ³²

¹ North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) U.S. Census Bureau

<https://www.census.gov/naics/>

² ⁸ ⁹ ¹¹ ¹² ¹³ ¹⁵ ²⁰ ²³ Industry Classification Overview

https://www.bls.gov/ces/naics/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

³ 22.6 percent of workers teleworked in March 2026 : The Economics Daily : U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

<https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2026/22-6-percent-of-workers-teleworked-in-march-2026.htm>

⁴ The NAICS 2022 update and its effect on BLS employment ...

https://www.bls.gov/opub/mlr/2023/article/the-naics-2022-update-and-its-effect-on-bls-employment-estimates-in-the-retail-trade-sector.htm?utm_source=chatgpt.com

⁵ 2022 North American Industry Classification System ...

https://www.bls.gov/respondents/ars/2022-naics.htm?utm_source=chatgpt.com

⁶ ³¹ Post, edit, and close a job in Recruiter | LinkedIn Help

<https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a415045/manage-your-job-posts-with-linkedin-recruiter?intendedLocale=ro&lang=en-us>

⁷ Concepts and Definitions (CPS) : U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

<https://www.bls.gov/cps/definitions.htm>

¹⁰ ¹⁶ ²⁶ Foundational Course on Statistical Business Registers

https://unstats.un.org/unsd/classifications/Workshops/Santiago2025/2.1_UNSD_Introductio_to_ISIC_Rev5.pdf

¹⁴ ¹⁷ ¹⁸ ²² ²⁸ ²⁹ Economic Census by Industry

https://www.census.gov/programs-surveys/economic-census/data/tables/industry.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com

¹⁹ 15-2051.00 - Data Scientists

https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/15-2051.00?utm_source=chatgpt.com

²¹ UNSD — Classification Detail

<https://unstats.un.org/unsd/classifications/Family/Detail/27>

²⁴ SOC home : U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

<https://www.bls.gov/soc/>

²⁵ NAICS Supersectors

https://www.bls.gov/sae/additional-resources/naics-supersectors-for-ces-program.htm?utm_source=chatgpt.com

²⁷ Recruiter and Recruiter Lite search filters and definitions | Recruiter Help

<https://www.linkedin.com/help/recruiter/answer/a414428>

30 North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) at ...

https://www.bls.gov/bls/naics.htm?utm_source=chatgpt.com

32 Filter candidates by industry in Recruiter and Talent Insights | Recruiter Help

<https://www.linkedin.com/help/recruiter/answer/a1425422>